

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES

History Department

MARKING & FEEDBACK POLICY

Approved for Academic Year 2026–2027

Head of History: Department Lead

Part 1: Departmental Rationale & Policy

The History Department prioritizes meaningful, manageable, and motivating feedback by focusing on the impact of teacher interventions rather than performative volume. In line with this, the department has shifted its primary focus toward handwritten work completed directly in pupil printed workbooks.

Formal assessments are recorded centrally, while individual feedback is delivered through live verbal coaching and whole-class modelling to ensure student effort is redirected into active reflection and improvement rather than administrative record-keeping.

Centring Pupil Voice

Feedback is a two-way dialogue, not a monologue. Our policy is fundamentally driven by **Pupil Voice**. Throughout all lessons, live marking requires pupils to vocalize their understanding and misconceptions during teacher coaching. Furthermore, at the end of every unit, pupils complete structured reflections to explicitly voice what they found engaging or challenging, directly informing and adapting future teacher planning.

Presentation & Workbooks

The history department utilizes structured A4 workbooks for all Key Stage 3 year groups and GCSE Mastery Booklets for Key Stage 4. This reduces the reliance on loose worksheets and the time spent managing traditional exercise books. By pairing these structured workbooks with our bespoke digital learning app, we create a unified system: the app drives retrieval practice and interactive revision, while the workbook provides a permanent, high-quality physical record for extended writing and core knowledge.

Frequency of Marking

Key Stage 3

Teachers will provide two pieces of feedback-focused homework each half term: one 'Read Out Loud' task (self-graded on Teams) to support literacy across the curriculum, and one short written piece graded by the teacher using the KS3 levels. Routine classwork is not formally stamped; instead, teacher time is reinvested into high-quality planning and live verbal feedback during lessons.

Key Stage 4

At Key Stage 4, there is increased flexibility in assessment methods depending on the unit being studied. Generally, this involves ongoing, low-stakes informal assessment conducted at regular intervals in class. Feedback is primarily delivered verbally, focusing on teacher modelling of answers and exam technique, with a particular emphasis on source-based questions.

To ensure progress is monitored effectively, a formal tracking sheet is utilized within Teams Assignments. This includes CAT4 target grades, which serve as a minimum target rate with the clear aspiration for pupils to exceed them.

Part 2: Standards, Grading & Feedback Types

Types of Marking & Feedback

Live In-The-Moment Marking

Intervention marking within the lesson to prompt deeper thinking and address misconceptions. Occurs through effective verbal questioning to clarify or refocus tasks.

Self & Peer Assessment

Pupils are given regular opportunities to assess their own or peers' work against explicit success criteria or structured checklists before teacher corroboration.

End of Unit Assessments & Pupil Voice

Written feedback based on set criteria or formal mark schemes. Following assessment, pupils complete the **Pupil Reflection Area** in their workbooks to document progress and set forward targets.

Automated Digital Marking

Spaced retrieval quizzes set on our custom history app provide instant self-marking and diagnostic feedback, with completion monitored centrally.

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (SPaG)

We follow the English department's marking guide to set clear, consistent standards across the humanities:

Symbol	Meaning	Symbol	Meaning
Sp	Incorrect spelling	^	Word omitted
P	Punctuation issue	?	Meaning is unclear
G	Grammar problem	!	Basic historical error
C	Capital letter needed	✓	Good point / valid evidence
//	New paragraph needed	✓✓	Exceptional point / insight

Assessment & Grading Framework

Recording Progress: Progress tracking is maintained using the assessment grid located on the inside front cover of the pupil workbooks. **Progress Categories:** Awarded based on work produced against set success criteria:

Pathway Level	Percentage Band	GCSE Indicative Grades
GD (Greater Depth)	80% – 100%	Grades 8 – 9
Exp + (Expected +)	60% – 79%	Grades 6 – 7
Exp (Expected)	40% – 59%	Grades 4 – 5
EM + (Emerging +)	30% – 39%	Grade 3
EM (Emerging)	10% – 29%	Grades 1 – 2

Part 3: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 3)

VISUAL APPENDIX •
KS3

To illustrate the policy in practice, every Key Stage 3 student workbook incorporates systematic front-cover tracking and back-page pupil reflection:

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER				TARGET GRADE: _____
Level	Emerging (1-3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)	
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Lesson 11: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?				
L2: Lesson 21: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?				
L3: Lesson 31: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?				
L4: Lesson 41: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?				
L5: Lesson 51: Domes Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?				
L6: Lesson 61: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?				
L7: Lesson 71: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?				
L8: Lesson 81: The Wars of the Roses (1455-1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?				
L9: Lesson 91: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?				
Final Unit Grade:				

Figure 1: Inside Front Cover Progress & Assessment Tracker (KS3 Workbook). Lesson-by-lesson chronological audit trail tracking Effort (1–5), Pathway standard, and teacher/self dialogue.

Inside Front Cover Tracking Grid

Serves as an ongoing dialogue between pupil, teacher, and parents:

- **Effort Logging (1–5):** Fosters personal responsibility and evaluates active participation.
- **Pathway Level:** Records progress towards Greater Depth (GD) against National Curriculum criteria.
- **Formative Feedback:** Focuses teacher comments on actionable praise and immediate targets.

Effort Scoring Rubric (1–5)

Score	Pupil Focus & Diligence
5 • Exemplary	Proactive curiosity; voluntary extension; impeccable pride.
4 • Good	Consistent engagement; thoughtful contributions; complete work.
3 • Satisfactory	Meets baseline; requires occasional prompting.
2 • Inconsistent	Incomplete written tasks; frequent off-task reminders.
1 • Concern	Persistent passivity; triggers departmental intervention.

Visual Evidence: End-of-Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice	
Unit: Medieval England (1066–1485)	
Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest – this is your chance to use your Pupil Voice to help your teacher plan future lessons.	
1. What Went Well (WWW) What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?	
2. Even Better If (EBI) What did you find most challenging? Are there any examples you are still confused about?	
3. Effort & Target Setting Circle your effort level for this unit: 1 (Low) 2 3 4 5 (Excellent) What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?	
Teacher Feedback & Coaching (To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)	

Figure 2: End of Unit Reflection & Two-Way Pupil Voice (Workbook Final Page). Students document successes (WWW), voice misconceptions for reteaching (EBI), self-score effort (1–5), and set forward targets validated by teacher coaching.

Part 3: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 4)

VISUAL APPENDIX •
KS4

At Key Stage 4, feedback is structured through PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, mastery booklets, and targeted exam question intelligence:

SECTION B PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (36+4 MARKS TOTAL)				Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified
Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Pupil Score	
Complete 4-Era Knowledge Vault (All 280 Recall Questions)	Checklist	/280	_____	
Round 1 (Stepped): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Medieval vs Renaissance)	Stepped Ladder	/4	_____	
Round 1 (Stepped): Q4 Explain Why (Surgical Progress c1700-c1900)	Stepped Ladder	/12	_____	
Round 1 (Stepped): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Germ Theory vs Public Health)	Stepped Ladder	/16+4	_____	
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Great Plague vs Black Death)	Dual Track	/4	_____	
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q4 Explain Why (Penicillin Mass Production c1938-45)	Dual Track	/12	_____	
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Four Humours c1250-c1700)	Dual Track	/16+4	_____	
Round 3 (Simulation): Section B Full Exam Hall Simulation (Q3, Q4, Q5/6)	Exam Pitch (55m)	/36+4	_____	
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM PRACTICE MARKS:		/104	_____ / 104	
Teacher / Peer Marker: _____		Date: _____	Overall Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]	

Figure 3: GCSE Section B Progress & Assessment Tracker (Edexcel Medicine Mastery Booklet). Maps student progression across Round 1 (Stepped Enquiries with PEE/PEEL Structure Strips and Causal Connective Banks), Round 2 (Dual-Track Enquiries for Grades 7–9), and Round 3 (Timed 55-minute Exam Hall Simulations).

Specification-Specific PEE/PEEL Structure Strips

- Paper 1 (Western Front):** Feature questions exist *strictly* as two separate 2-mark questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- Paper 2 (Elizabethan):** Two distinct 2-mark feature questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- Paper 2 (Middle East):** Updated single 4-mark consequence format ('Explain one consequence of...').

Provenance Clues ('How Useful' PEE/PEEL Structure Strips)

Explicit prompt boxes guide students to evaluate **Author** (role, firsthand access), **Audience** (private diary vs propaganda), and **Motive** (purpose of publication), moving beyond generic utility comments.

Longitudinal Exam Trend Intelligence & Automated Quizzing

QUESTION FOCUS	2018	2019	2020	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Section A: Western Front Historic Environment Enquiry 16m (Q1 Features: 4m • Q2a Utility: 6m • Q2b Follow-Up: 4m)	SECTION A 16m Treatment of Battle Injuries Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Gas Attacks Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Gas Attacks Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Trench Foot Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m New Techniques to Deal with Injuries Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Medical Staff in Casualty Clearing Stations Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Difficulties in Caring for the Wounded Along Evacuation Chain Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A 16m Transporting Wounded Along Evacuation Chain Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m
Q3: Similarity / Difference 4m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q3 [4m] Medieval vs Industrial Hospital Care	Q3 [4m] Ideas About Causes of Illness: 18th/19th Century vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Medieval Physician vs NHS Doctor	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Industrial	Q3 [4m] Prevention of Illness: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Treatment of Infectious Diseases: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Epidemics: Great Plague (1665) vs Cholera (1854)	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Modern
Q4: Causation Explanation 12m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q4 [12m] Prevention of Illness c1700-present	Q4 [12m] Renaissance Medical Knowledge c1500-c1700	Q4 [12m] Science & Technology in Modern Medicine c1900-present	Q4 [12m] Attitudes Towards Surgery c1800-present	Q4 [12m] Access to Medical Care & Treatment in Modern Period	Q4 [12m] Why Little Change in Medieval Medicine c1250-c1500	Q4 [12m] Impact of Pasteur's Germ Theory c1861-present	Q4 [12m] Hospital Care & Treatment Improvements c1700-c1900
Q5: Judgement Essay (Choice A) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q5 [16m] Understanding Cause of Disease c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Galen & Medieval Medical Care c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Florence Nightingale & Hospital Care c1700-c1900	Q5 [16m] Medieval Care & Treatment: Role of Physician c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Thomas Sydenham as Key Turning Point c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Progress in Medical Knowledge in Renaissance c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Four Humours & Medicine c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Medieval Ideas on Cause of Illness: Religion vs Nature c1250-c1500
Q6: Judgement Essay (Choice B) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q6 [16m] Advances in Surgery: 18th/19th Century vs 20th Century	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Medicine c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Infectious Diseases c1500-c1900	Q6 [16m] Pasteur & Causes of Illness c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Attitudes Towards Illness c1700-c1900	Q6 [16m] Role of Individuals in Prevention c1700-present	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Hospital Care c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Science & Technology as Main Reason for Modern Progress c1900-present

Figure 4: Pearson Edexcel Past Exam Question Matrix (8-Series Analysis, 2018–2026). Departmental tracking across Medicine, Elizabethan, Middle East, Germany, and USA. Flags overdue question tariffs and unexamined syllabus themes, allowing teachers to deliver high-yield classroom rehearsals and automated 20-question mastery quizzes.